

Website Handoff Notes

This document gives the technical facts and the decisions for the handoff of **nme.fas.harvard.edu**. It is a companion to the Maintenance Guide.

Repository: github.com/christopherruano/carmody_lab_website Date: July 2026

Handoff

Facts about the website

- **Type:** a static website. It uses only HTML, CSS, and JavaScript. It has no build step, no framework, and no server. This is on purpose. A non-technical person can maintain it.
- **Repository:** github.com/christopherruano/carmody_lab_website . It is on Chris's personal account.
- **Hosting:** GitHub Pages. It serves the `main` branch from the root folder.
- **Address:** nme.fas.harvard.edu . The `CNAME` file and a Harvard FAS DNS record set this address.
- **Deploy:** push to the `main` branch. GitHub Pages then rebuilds the website in about 1 minute. There is no manual publish step.

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One important point about the structure

The file `js/main.js` is the center of the website. It puts the navigation menu and the footer on each page. It also holds the search index, the slideshow captions, and the code for the research tabs and the news button.

! The menu, the footer, and the search are in this one file. They are not on each page. Each editor, a person or an AI, must know this fact. The file `CLAUDE.md` gives this information. Claude Code reads `CLAUDE.md` automatically.

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Access: the chosen method

- ◆ **Decision: make Rachel an Admin.** The repository stays on Chris's account. Rachel gets full control. This does not change the hosting or the DNS.

Open `github.com/christopherruano/carmody_lab_website` . Go to Settings. Go to Collaborators and teams. Select Add people. Add Rachel with the **Admin** role. Add one more lab member as an Admin also. Then the access does not depend on one person.

A full transfer of ownership was an option. We did not choose it. A transfer needs a DNS change with Harvard FAS. Do a transfer only if a person closes Chris's account. The Claude account for Claude Code is separate from GitHub. Rachel must have her own Claude account.

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Handoff checklist

- ☐ Add Rachel and one more person as **Admins** on the repository.
- ☐ Make sure GitHub Pages is on. Open Settings, then Pages. The custom domain must read `name.fas.harvard.edu` . HTTPS must be on.
- ☐ Copy the repository to Rachel's computer or the lab computer.
- ☐ Install Claude Code on that computer. Sign in with a lab Claude account. Make sure the `claude` command starts in the website folder.
- ☐ Do one test change together, from start to end. Add a test news item. Publish it. Look at the website. Then remove the test item. This step is the most useful part of the handoff.
- ☐ Write down the contact for Harvard FAS or HEB IT, for DNS problems.

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The content bot (forms)

A GitHub Action lets Rachel or Amar make the most common changes from a form, with no terminal: add a news item; add, edit, or remove a lab member; add a publication; and change text on a page.

- The forms are in `.github/ISSUE_TEMPLATE/` . The workflow is `.github/workflows/content-bot.yml` . The generators are in `scripts/` .
- A form makes an issue. The workflow runs the correct generator, edits the files, and **commits straight to the main branch (auto-publish)**. The change is on the website in about 1 minute. There is no review step.
- If a generator cannot do the change, it fails, nothing is committed, and the bot writes a comment on the issue. **To undo a change, revert its commit** (the history keeps every version) or ask Claude Code.
- The generators are deterministic. They do not use an AI. There is no API key and no cost for each use.
- The workflow runs only for a repository collaborator. A `concurrency` group publishes one change at a time.

- To put back a review step, replace the "Publish to the website" step with a `gh pr create` step (the git history has this earlier version).
- Claude Code does all other changes. To add another form, copy the pattern (a form, a `scripts/*.mjs` , and a branch in the workflow router). `CLAUDE.md` has the details.

The documents in the repository

FILE	FUNCTION
README.md	The start page. It points to the guides.
Maintenance-Guide.pdf	The maintenance guide for Rachel.
CLAUDE.md	The guide for AI assistants. Claude Code reads it automatically.
Handoff-Notes.pdf	This document.

Rachel can do all the tasks in the maintenance guide alone. She can undo each task through the GitHub record. A technical person must help with these tasks: a change to the domain or the `CNAME` file, a change to the layout or the CSS, or a change to the GitHub Pages or DNS settings.